

Form-Based Codes / Design-led zoning

What this tool produces · *A legally binding municipal zoning document that regulates the physical form, massing, and relationship of buildings to the public realm across a rural-to-urban transect.*

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Regulation

Spatial

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Form-Based Codes / Design-led zoning*

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Why this tool matters

Rewriting the fundamental DNA of the city's legal code so that every new development naturally grows into a vibrant, pedestrian-friendly neighborhood, effectively outlawing the isolation of urban sprawl.

Evidence we produce

A legally binding municipal zoning document that regulates the physical form, massing, and relationship of buildings to the public realm across a rural-to-urban transect.

Duration & Material

Duration · 12 to 24 months for drafting and legal adoption

Material · The SmartCode template, GIS mapping, public charrette materials, architectural rendering software

Reference case

Communities utilizing the SmartCode framework apply generative coding to restructure their regulatory environment. By calibrating building orientation, street lighting design, and mixed-use requirements based on specific transect zones, municipalities have successfully created lively urban centers that promote shared prosperity, drastically reducing the vehicle miles traveled while boosting local economic vitality.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Rural-to-urban transect · 6 zones × form rules

Duration
12 to 24 months for drafting and legal adoption

T1 · Natural no development	T2 · Rural farmland · scattered	T3 · Sub-urban low density · garden	T4 · General urban mixed-use · mid-rise	T5 · Urban centre dense · attached	dense · vertical
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Calibrate frontages, heights, setbacks, parking by transect.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.